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DEPARTMENT OF VISUAL ART & DESIGN

August 10, 2026

Dear Rank and Tenure Committee,

Please accept this letter of recommendation in full support of Vlad Veksler's application for promotion to associate professor. Vlad is an excellent colleague who works hard to ensure that students, his fellow faculty, and programs succeed.

As a professor and chair of the Department of Visual Art & Design, I have worked closely with Vlad on several occasions, and each time he proved to be a generous and congenial colleague. My first encounter with Vlad occurred just after he had arrived and began designing a new UI/UX minor. He invited our department (among others) to contribute, which revealed his inclusive approach to program building. We had many discussions about how to bridge computer science and graphic design, and we discussed potentially team-teaching a course on UI/UX design; this happened for the first time this past spring semester. The collaboration allowed students to concretely see how the two disciplines intersect while also equipping them with skills that they will need in the ever-changing landscape of digital technology and graphic design. Given his collegiality and hard work, I asked him to be an outside committee member during our search for a full-time graphic design professor (Jing Dong's position) two years ago. He was delightful, dependable, insightful and diligent, and thus an invaluable addition to the committee. We have also worked closely with Vlad on creating a maker space that operates in our department's woodworking shop, which has been used by the robotics club. Currently, we seek to expand this space and thus provide more opportunities for experimenting with contemporary technologies, and Vlad has eagerly contributed. In all instances Vlad is open, supportive, and an active member of these efforts and we look forward to future collaborations.

As Co-Chair of the Faculty Development Committee, Vlad also demonstrates his commitment to and support of his fellow faculty. Under his leadership, for example, the committee has greatly improved opportunities for faculty, and in my experience, it has never been more active. In every task, Vlad maintains a positive demeanor, always seeing the best in everyone and every situation. He is a wonderful colleague who contributes much to the community at Caldwell University and we are much better off for his presence. Therefore, I totally and without any reservation support his application.

Sincerely,

Jennifer Noonan, Ph.D.

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